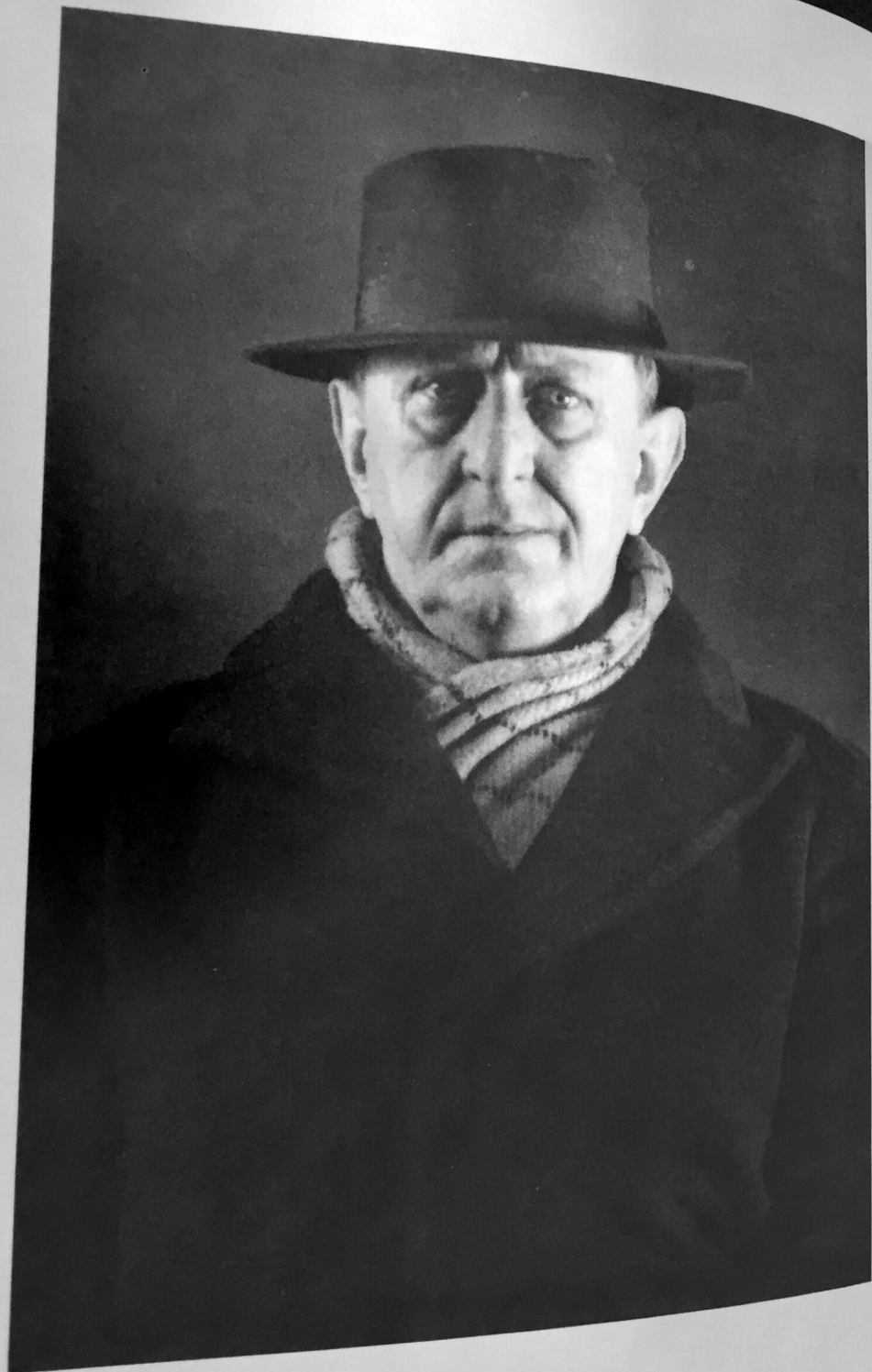




THE COLLECTED POEMS
OF
MARSDEN HARTLEY
1904-1943

Edited by
GAIL R. SCOTT

Foreword by
Robert Creeley

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Albert Ryder—Moonlightist

Moonlight severing his ancient mariner's
beard
and falling over the cliffs of his eyebrows
his lips fearing to touch what was no
longer available
night streaming through his listless fingers
with the texture of impassible days to come
hanging like limpid moss from his prophet
shoulders—
this beautiful man, suffering from the weight
of majesty of dream
because he had been denied substance of
any other truth—dream so sumptuous—heavy
with failures of death radiant with shimmer
of new belief.
I am speaking of Albert Ryder moonlightist
as I knew him—
"I asked him to Christmas dinner," the lady
said to me, who had a long time known him,
"he said he would come, we waited two hours
for him—the party eager to see him—he did
not come."
Next time she saw him—"O we were so
disappointed you did not come"—
"I was there," said Ryder, "I looked through the
window—saw the lovely lights—it was very beautiful."

Eilshemius

If you had sat with Eilshemius
quieted him with silence or calmed
words
you have seen thin rays of moonlight
quiver on his lips—noted the vast
miseries he suffered—crucifixion of
loneliness—heard the newspapers rattle
upon his chest—try them—they will keep
you warm he said to a famous woman
painter—
"When she died"—meaning his loved one—
"I thought I couldn't live she was so
beautiful
suddenly out of the window I saw the moon—
and I said to myself—I can live for that—
that is beauty"—
It was the sun that forgave and forgot
him.

Marianne Moore

Like a surgeon at the drugged decisive
table
opening the cicatrice carefully, to find
what ails the sentence—separate fruit
from rind
the sickness of the hyper-trammelled theme
or shake the skeleton of a proved factitious
thought
noon-high with genteel cool perspicacity
heart left to fend for itself since it
is not asked to even speak its piece
for casual concordance of timed release
benight her—we might add—for keeping poetry
from bending fallacious knee or breathe
too heavily in areas conspicuously forlorn
for which it was never born.